

The 6:15

MONDAY · SEPTEMBER 7, 2026

NO. 11

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Sun 9/6 (yest.)	OPEC+ core-7 held October quotas at September levels (Saudi 10.478m bpd, Russia 9.949m, Iraq 4.431m, Kuwait 2.676m, Kazakhstan 1.628m, Algeria 1.007m, Oman 841k), citing Hormuz-driven uncertainty; next review 2027.
Mon 9/7 (today)	Labor Day — NYSE, Nasdaq and the bond market closed. Asia/Europe trade as usual.
Tue 9/8	Canada's dollar-for-dollar tariffs on ~\$27.6B of U.S. imports take effect.
Wed 9/10	Adobe (ADBE) reports fiscal Q3 after close. Cons. adj. EPS ~\$6.08-6.09 on \$6.67-6.72B revenue — within Adobe's own guidance range.
Thu 9/11	Aug. CPI, 8:30a (BLS) — cons. headline +0.4% m/m/3.4% y/y, core +0.1% m/m/2.5% y/y. The print Fed Gov. Waller named as decisive for his Sept. vote.
Mon 9/14	Oracle (ORCL) reports after close.
Tue-Wed 9/15-16	FOMC decision/SEP Wed 2p, presser 2:30p. Hike odds ~60% (CME FedWatch, post-jobs-report) vs. a coin flip Thursday.
AI — [DEVELOPING]	GPT-6 Astra now live in the API and for all Pro/Enterprise/Business-Premium users in Work & Codex (as of 9/6); broader ChatGPT rollout still in progress.
AI IPO — [DEVELOPING]	Anthropic still targeting an IPO prospectus release this week, public listing late Sept./early Oct., per The Information [reported, not confirmed] .

No verified rocket launch or VC round of comparable scale to Nvidia-Hugging Face (see Business) fell inside this run's window; sub-bullet skipped.

METRICS · AS OF ~6:15A ET MON 9/7 — US MARKETS CLOSED FOR LABOR DAY

Brent / WTI	\$97.39 (Mon a.m., +1.15% vs. Fri), on the Iran-Hormuz naval clash; WTI last ~\$93.22 (Fri range), no holiday settle located
2Y / 10Y / 30Y	10Y 4.784% (Fri close, +2bp+ on jobs report); 2Y 4.37% (highest since Jan. 2025); 30Y 5.24% — bond market closed today
DXY	98.92-99.39 range Fri, last ~99.0-99.2
S&P / Nasdaq futures	no reliable Globex print located for the holiday session
VIX	closed 14.53 Sat 9/5 (+1.47%)
Dow / S&P / Nasdaq	53,414.25 (-0.51%, -271.86pts) / 7,718.60 (-0.38%) / 26,506.99 (-0.29%) — Fri close, jobs-report reaction
Asia & Europe	Nikkei 66,399.84 (+2.12%); Kospi 6,995.39 (+4.61%); CSI 300 +0.59%; Hang Seng lower (energy/edu -0.7 to -1.1%); Stoxx 600 -0.1%, DAX -0.14%, FTSE 100 flat, CAC 40 +0.1%
Gold / retail gas	gold \$4,476.60/oz (Sat 9/5); gas \$4.15/gal natl. avg (AAA, 9/6), up from \$4.1474 Thu

Bond market and equity exchanges are closed for Labor Day; rates and futures rows reflect Friday's last cash-market prints rather than a fresh session.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 190 since the Feb. 28 declaration (straits.live) vs. "Day 191" (globalsecurity.org, different start date)
Transits	6 vessels Aug. 30 vs. ~85/day pre-crisis baseline (straits.live) — ~7% of normal throughput stale, no fresher count
Dark tankers	no current share figure located this run
Strikes (24h)	major escalation Sat. 9/5 — IRGC fired 2 ballistic missiles at a US carrier and destroyer; both evaded (see Iran & Hormuz)
War-risk premia	~\$10.0M per VLCC passage, ~40x pre-crisis (straits.live); unchanged order of magnitude

Kpler's near-real-time AIS counts, straits.live/PortWatch baseline snapshots, and trade-press war-risk estimates measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged against each other.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	dropped the rubber game 4-3 to the Padres Sun., lost the weekend series 1-2. Now 81-61, 3.5 games behind Tampa Bay (84-57); hold the top AL wild card
Knicks	Josh Hart extension still unsigned as of 9/3 — eligible for up to 4-yr/\$132M; league sources see 3-yr/\$54-62M as more likely
Northwestern	opened 1-0, beat South Dakota State 34-18 (9/5) in Aidan Chiles' debut

LEAD

BLOWOUT JOBS REPORT REPRICES THE FED

August payrolls nearly triple consensus and revise two prior months higher, snapping hike odds back toward 60% just as Friday's dovish Fed break looked settled

Friday's August jobs report delivered the opposite of what Thursday's market had positioned for. Nonfarm payrolls rose 162,000, nearly triple the Dow Jones consensus of 53,000, while the unemployment rate held at 4.1% as expected. The report also revised June up 11,000 (to +31,000) and July up 44,000 (to +21,000 from an initial -23,000 decline) — a combined 55,000 additional jobs across the two months that had anchored the dovish case for a Fed hold. Average hourly earnings rose 0.3% (\$0.10) to \$37.75, up 3.1% year-over-year — a wage print still consistent with cooling, even as headline job growth ran hot. Gains concentrated in food services (+59,000) and local government education (+42,000); information employment fell 23,000, tied to cuts at computing-infrastructure and data-processing firms.

The market reaction inverted Thursday's Waller-driven rally. The Dow fell 271.86 points (-0.51%) to 53,414.25, the S&P 500 slid

0.38% to 7,718.60, and the Nasdaq Composite eased 0.29% to 26,506.99. Treasury yields jumped in the other direction from Thursday's drop: the 10-year rose more than 2bp to 4.784%, and the 2-year touched its highest level since January 2025. CME FedWatch's implied probability of a September hike, which had collapsed to roughly a coin flip after Gov. Waller's Thursday remarks, snapped back to about 60.3%. Waller himself weighed in the same day: the report, he said, was "consistent with full employment" rather than the rising-unemployment, broader-stress combination that might have pushed him toward easing — a notably different tone from Thursday's "give disinflation a chance" framing, even as he stopped short of retracting his openness to a hold.

The mechanism is straightforward: a report nearly 3x consensus, with meaningful upward revisions attached, is difficult for a data-dependent Fed to wave off, even one governor's public dissent notwithstanding. Waller's own stated line in the sand was never the payrolls number — he named Thursday's Sept. 11 CPI print as the release that would determine his vote, arguing he could support a hold "if disinflation continues." A hot jobs report doesn't contradict that framework directly, since it speaks to labor-market strength rather than price pressure. But it does change the political economy inside the committee: a Warsh-led majority that had already moved to 66% hike odds after Jackson Hole now has fresh labor-market ammunition independent of the inflation data, narrowing the room for Waller's dissent to carry the room even if Thursday's CPI comes in soft. The net effect is that Thursday's CPI print — already the single most-watched release on the Board's ten-day calendar — now carries even more weight: a hot number all but locks in a hike; a soft one no longer settles the question on its own, given Friday's labor-

market strength sits in the other pan of the scale. The one thread that cuts the other way is the information-sector loss — 23,000 jobs tied to computing-infrastructure and data-processing firms — which some desks read as the labor-market face of the same AI-driven efficiency push showing up in enterprise capex elsewhere in this issue; a headline beat built partly on a shrinking tech-adjacent payroll is a messier signal than the topline number suggests.

Two threads carried into the weekend alongside the jobs report. Nvidia confirmed a \$12.9-13B all-but-final agreement to acquire Hugging Face — \$11.9B to shareholders plus roughly \$1B in retention equity for staff — in a deal expected to close in the first half of 2027 pending regulatory approval; it is Nvidia's second-largest purchase after last year's \$20B Groq-assets deal, and the company said Nvidia compute will not be required to build on or deploy through the platform. And the weekend's more consequential development, mechanically separate from markets but not from the Board's oil line, was a direct Iran-US naval engagement Saturday — the first time in this war that Iranian forces have targeted US Navy vessels rather than commercial tankers. *That shift, detailed in Iran & Hormuz below, is arguably the bigger story of the weekend for escalation risk, even though its market footprint so far is limited to Brent's push toward \$97 — a reminder that the crosscurrents this reader carries onto Tuesday's reopened session run wider than Friday's payroll print alone.*

POLITICS

An NBC News poll released over the weekend found 69% of respondents in key midterm races oppose new AI data-center construction in their areas, a finding campaigns in swing districts are

already citing as a live 2026 issue. Trump told reporters the MAGA Inc. super PAC plans to spend \$400-500M on midterm races. A federal judge temporarily blocked a Trump-directed Postal Service rule that would have given the agency more control over mail-in ballot handling, and the Missouri Supreme Court ruled a new Republican-drawn congressional map cannot be used in this year's elections — two rulings that, taken together, preserve more of the current ballot-access and district landscape through November than the administration and state Republicans had been pushing for. Republicans hold the House 218-214 (three vacancies) and the Senate 53-45 (two independents caucus with Democrats) heading into the Nov. 3 midterms.

ECONOMICS

Fed funds remain targeted at 3.50%-3.75%; a hike at the Sept. 15-16 meeting would take the range to 3.75%-4.00%. Friday's report was the last full employment read before that decision — the September payrolls report doesn't arrive until Oct. 2, after the meeting — which leaves Thursday's CPI as the only scheduled data point left to move the committee either way before it votes. That CPI print now lands the same morning as the next weekly jobless-claims release, putting two of the cycle's most-watched data points five days ahead of the decision on a single Thursday. Markets closed for Labor Day mean no cash-session confirmation of Friday's repricing until Tuesday's reopen; no reliable Globex futures print was located for the holiday session itself (see Board).

BUSINESS

Nvidia's Hugging Face acquisition (see Lead) was the session's other major corporate move; against Nvidia's roughly \$200B in projected calendar-year free cash flow, it was described by observers as a platform bet rather than a balance-sheet stretch. Hugging Face's platform serves more than 18 million developers and hosts upward of 3 million models used by more than 200,000 companies; Nvidia said its own compute will not be required to build on or deploy through the platform, which will keep supporting multi-cloud, multi-accelerator development. Separately, Amazon's FTC fight escalated from statement to formal litigation: the FTC and 22 states filed suit Aug. 31 alleging Amazon secretly converted its nominally "second-price" Sponsored Products/Brands/Display auctions into de facto first-price auctions roughly 80% of the time since 2019, overcharging about 1.2 million advertisers by more than \$20B. Amazon's formal response calls the suit "misguided," disputes any evidence of consumer harm, and says its auction systems saved advertisers \$8B between 2021 and 2025. No new movement on Broadcom's post-earnings selloff or Apple's leadership transition surfaced this run.

TECHNOLOGY

GPT-6 Astra's rollout advanced through the weekend: as of Sept. 6 it is live in the API and available to all ChatGPT Pro, Enterprise and Business-Premium users in Work and Codex, with the Plus/Business Work-and-Codex tier also fully rolled out; broader ChatGPT web and app availability is still pending. The model carries a 1M-token context window and is priced roughly 2.5x its predecessor GPT-5.6 Sol's rate — the premium OpenAI is asking enterprise customers to pay for the capability jump — and OpenAI says it's nearly 2x faster than that predecessor at Computer Use tasks. Anthropic is still on

track to release its IPO prospectus this week, targeting a public listing in late September or early October per a report from The Information; the company has been in confidential S-1 discussions with the SEC since a June 1 filing. Analysts estimate Anthropic posted its first operating profit — roughly \$559M on \$10.9B of quarterly revenue — in the second quarter, the kind of number a prospectus would need to substantiate reported raise targets near \$130B against a valuation above \$2T. **[profit, raise and valuation figures reported, not confirmed by the company]**

GEOPOLITICS

Russia struck eight Ukrainian regions overnight into Sept. 5 with Iskander-M/KN-23 ballistic missiles and 167 strike drones, concentrating on Dnipropetrovsk metallurgical plants that supply Ukraine's defense-industrial base along with logistics centers and power substations. The strikes came as a US delegation conducted shuttle diplomacy between the two capitals — meeting Putin in Moscow and traveling on to Kyiv — and to accommodate the visit, Zelensky agreed to a pause on long-range strikes against Moscow and Kyiv through the end of Sept. 7, while Putin separately ordered a matching three-day halt on strikes against Kyiv from midnight Sept. 5. The talks produced no diplomatic breakthrough; Zelensky said Sunday "we expect the war will continue" and that Ukraine is counting on US energy and air-defense support heading into winter.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Saturday marked a qualitative escalation in the Hormuz conflict: Iran's IRGC fired two ballistic missiles at a US aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer operating near the strait. CENTCOM said both vessels "successfully evaded multiple unprovoked Iranian attacks" with no American personnel injured, and that US forces struck back the same day, permanently disabling two Iranian tankers — M/T Downy off Kharg Island and M/T Stark 1 near Jask — and hitting the unladen carrier M/T Kylo in the Gulf of Oman. CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper framed the response as deliberately disproportionate: "If you shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours." It is the first time in this war that Iranian forces have targeted

US Navy assets directly rather than commercial or Iranian-flagged shipping — a shift from the tanker-war pattern, one experts quoted by regional press have called a "calculated escalation" as both sides fight for control of the strait. A separate IRGC claim of an attack on a US unmanned vessel, timestamped 4:47a ET Sept. 7, remains single-sourced and disputed by US officials. **[single-sourced, disputed, treat as unconfirmed]** The strait itself remains at Day 190 of closure per straits.live, with the Board above carrying the latest transit, war-risk and methodology figures; Saturday's exchange is the clearest sign yet that the conflict's center of gravity is shifting from interdicting tankers to direct confrontation with the US Navy presence in the Gulf.

SPORTS

Yankees	L 4-3 to Padres Sun., lost weekend series 1-2. Now 81-61, 3.5 games behind Tampa Bay (84-57); hold the top AL wild card
Knicks	Josh Hart extension still unsigned; talks ongoing, no new figure reported since 9/3
Northwestern	opened 1-0, beat South Dakota State 34-18 in Aidan Chiles' debut

Continuity. Dropped as resolved/unchanged since 9/4: the Massachusetts Senate primary; Apple's CEO transition; the OPEC+ Sept. 6 meeting (resolved, see Board). Watching: Tuesday's reopened session for the first full-liquidity reaction to both the jobs report and the Iran-Hormuz naval clash; Thursday's Aug. CPI print; any US response to the unconfirmed Sept. 7 IRGC unmanned-vessel claim; Adobe's Wednesday earnings; Anthropic's IPO prospectus; further GPT-6 Astra rollout.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.